

Regular Meeting
Monday, October 15, 2018
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mr. Ruggiero, Superintendent Dr. Edouard Vincent, Associate Superintendent Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent of Finance Patterson, and Chioma Opara, Medford High School Representative.

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Vice Chairperson Mustone in the Council Chamber at 7:00 PM

Ms. Kreatz called the roll for attendance:

6 - present / 1 absent

Motion to approve Minutes of October 1st - Motion to approve by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Motion to approve Bills / Transfers of Funds - motion passes

Motion to approve payrolls - Motion to approve by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Report of Secretary - \$36,000 bill

Columbus Slide - still in process - might have ordered wrong part

Motion to approve and place on file, motion passes.

Report on MCAS -Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The MCAS data was reviewed at our October 2nd Committee of the Whole, and we had lengthy discussions on progress that we made and what areas we need to work on. We know we need to focus on math, but we will continue to focus on, science, ELA, and our assessments, as well. Ms. DiBenedetto - I just wanted to state again our growth in ELA due to the Journey's program. It took 3 years, but working together we can see the strides we have made. New programing and piloting programs are important. For example, the new science program, we might not see change immediately, but looking forward to seeing that work. I am also looking forward to the Lesley Partnership too. Motion to accept this report and place on file - motion passes.

Building & Grounds Sub Committee Meeting regarding the Roberts Playground status - Members of the sub committee are: Ms. Mustone, Chair, Ms. Kreatz and Ms. DiBenedetto. Ms. Mustone- We were notified by the contractor that the Interlocking bricks are no longer being produced, due to a UV question in the tiles. Assistant Superintendent Patterson - Actually it was the UV inhibitor that didn't seem to work well. We were offered an alternative product type, called a rubber bond pour and place. The CPA did approve the change, but we will have to re bid it due to the product change. We need to receive 2 more bids. Ms. Van der Kloot - This is very disappointing, as a broken tile, sounded easier to replace. What is the life expectancy of this alternative product? Ms. Patterson - The alternative product has a higher safety rating for falls and rubber bond pour and place is actually 2 components, a top coat sealant. Any replacement would have to be cut out and repoured. Ms. Van der Kloot - Thankfully it didn't move quicker, we would have had a problem in the future! Ms. DiBenedetto - I hope we can move forward quickly and get the other two quotes we need. Ms. Patterson - The process would take at least a week and a half: 3 days for removal, 3 days pour and place and 3 days for cure. However, it would be dependent on rain and temperatures over freezing

On the motion to approve this subcommittee report by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll Call Vote - (6)- in the affirmative (1) absent, motion passes

Community Participation - Jenny Graham - Cheryl Rodriquez, & Kristy Avino

Ms. Graham - announces Community Wide PTO for (4) elementary schools. Flyer in your packet. (20) people from all 4 elementary schools, have come together to get to know each other & work on joint fundraising, but doesn't take away from school's PTO's. Launched this weekend, Disney Vacation raffle. It will be hosted for next (2) months. Winner will need to pay taxes on the prize, so they could also opt to take the cash prize itself. Goal is to pick winning ticket at December 17th School Committee raffle. We do have to sell a certain amount of tickets. Ms. Van der Kloot - Who is donating the prize? Ms. Avino - Prize will be paid for by the selling of the tickets, so that is why we will have to sell a certain amount. Ms. Van der Kloot - This combined PTO is like reinventing Medford's Home & School Association. We fundraised city wide, as well as, brought in special events, like puppet show and the Boston Ballet. Working together people can do fantastic things. Ms. Rodriguez - In the Spring, the fundraiser will be Harlem Wizards, on March 13th in the MHS Gym, vs. celebrity teachers and staff. Tickets will cost (\$15 a piece). Ms. Graham - our third fundraiser will be an electronics recycling day. In addition, on Nov 6th, Election Day/PD Day, we worked with Mr. Maloney to offer skating at LoConte Rink for \$5 per student. The money raised will be shared amongst the 4 schools. We have also thought of hosting a gala to honor teachers in the district, as well as,

maybe bringing other schools into the group next fall. Right now, we are trying to schedule dates & times of when tickets will be sold. Ms. DiBenedetto - what about at 8th grade open house? Ms. Rodriguez - Unfortunately no, the MHS/MVTHS PTO has its own raffle. We will be selling at Friday's football game. Local businesses will also sell them. Ms. DiBenedetto - Motion to approve. Motion passes

Report of Superintendent - I wanted to update you on events that have gone on these past two weeks. Some of you joined with us at the Bistro 489 official opening. I attended my new Superintendent training in Marlboro in which we discussed our district's initiatives, as well as, Mayor Burke's Big Table Idea, which discussed issues facing our students including food, housing and health concerns. I am pleased to report that Yoki Restaurant hosted the 7th Annual Golf Tournament which benefits the Medford Family Network. It was held on Columbus Day and fielded (72) golfers and grossed \$5,000. We are very appreciative of Yoki's support of our Medford Family Network. The MHS Band hosted a band clinic at Hormel Stadium on Sunday. This event gave the Mustang Band and others the opportunity to have judges look at their performance and obtain a critique on their performance. This clinic enables bands to upgrade their performances. All of our fall sports teams are doing well. Lastly, for those who were able to attend the Kiwanis Taste of Italy event, you know what a nice afternoon that was. School Committee Member Paulette Van der Kloot was there. We appreciate the Kiwanis as they support so many programs in the Medford Public Schools.

I would like to update everyone on our Math Learning Walks that we conducted with Lesley University. I have said before, we used cross functional teams who utilized the same lens, i.e. the (5) Core Actions: Evidenced Based Responses, Productive Struggle, Academic Discourse, Access for All and Feedback. It was important that our teams all looked at same thing, and that we looked at all content areas including literacy. Please note, they we only were able to spend (15) minutes in each classroom and therefore did not see a full lesson from start to finish. We looked at approx (48) classrooms across all elementary schools. Environment was included in our learning walks, as well as, content. In every classroom observed 3 of the 5 core actions were found: Evidence, Academic, and Access, as well as, appropriate use of technology. What we did not see as much were: Productive and Feedback. Please note that the teachers had no idea what indicators we were using. Our school leaders have learned about the core actions and we will roll it out to our teachers. Core actions are a best practice and we will move forward in our professional development with it. All of our elementary classrooms were very warm and inviting. Motion to approve by Ms. Kreatz, motion carries.

Recommendation to approve Puerto Rico Trip - Ms. Nelida Lepore - We will be visiting Puerto Rico over February Vacation. This is our 5th trip utilizing the Vamonos Tour. Puerto Rico is part of the United States, and students will be able to use their spanish language skills if they so

choose. Ms. Van der Kloot - What is the cost per student? Ms. Lepore - The original cost was \$2800, but as our numbers increased, we now have (39) students registered, the cost was reduced to \$1,950; which includes the flight, hotel, & 2 meals a day. All the students took insurance for the trip which cost \$145, so students can cancel at anytime. Ms. Van der Kloot - Sounds like a wonderful trip. You have my support. Mr. Ruseau - Is (39) students the limit? Ms. Lepore - Yes, which equates to (1) chaperone for every (6) students. Ms. DiBenedetto - Thank you for giving our students the opportunity to see the world and combining that with service projects. Those students will return and be much more appreciative of what they have here. Ms. Kreatz - I see they will visit a local high school and volunteer at a school and work in the community. Have a great time and take a lot of photos. Mr. Ruggiero - Has the tour director been CORI cleared? Ms. Lepore - Yes. On the motion to approve by Ms. DiBenedetto and seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll Call Vote - 6 in the affirmative, (1) absent - Motion carries

Report on Safe Routes to School - Judith Crocker / Syrah McGiven (Board of Health) and Todd Blake (City Traffic Engineer) - powerpoint presentation in your packets. Update on the program - Promoting Sustainable Student Transportation. Ms. Crocker - In Massachusetts - 50 - 60 % of school participate in this program. It meets local needs: Physical Activity, Safety, Traffic Congestion, Envior, Attendance/Tardiness, as well as, the Six E's - Evaluation, education, encouragement, engineering, enforcement, equity. We encourage education about our program which discusses pedestrian and bike safety. We promote " walking school buses", which is walking and picking up your friends along the route. We also hope to educate crossing guards, police and school officers, and appropriate school traffic plans. The municipality has to work with schools to be safe

Brooks School 2013-2018 Infrastructure grant - \$1 Million

Roberts School - \$250 from 2018 parent survey

Roberts School - June 2018 suggest traffic flow improvements

Walk Medford - strong advocate for this program

So in Medford, we need to discuss where we go from here. We would like to jump start programs at Andrews / Partner with McGlynn E & MS, as well as, draft & communicate uniform arrival/dismissal plans that include text, maps & school hours. If this were to be adopted it would assist the City when making the Complete Streets applications. No matter how our students get to school, we want them to get there safely. Ms. McGivern - Syrah McGivern - Walk Medford / Board of Health- Our goal is to change policies to improve our health. We are here to work with Judy to help. We are hopeful Roberts will be eligible to receive the next grant. Ms. DiBenedetto - Is the Columbus participant? Ms. McGivern - Yes. Ms Van der Kloot - Ms.

Kreatz and I attended the Roberts event. It was positive start of their day. Thank you and I'm glad you plan to reach out to our principals at the McGlynn. Mr. Ruggiero - I see that we have 8%, participation but you hope for 30% ...how can we get closer to 30%? Ms. Crocker - It often depends where someone lives. What is their path to school? Some neighborhoods are more walkable, some rather take the school bus. We do know that New England roads are full of traffic, so we encourage walking, but it's more case by case. It doesn't do anyone any good to sit in traffic--- even in traffic to drop students off! Mr. Blake - City Traffic Engineer - Our goals are to improve and encourage more walking and promote non vehicle traffic. Cycling and walking are treated that same as vehicles. Uber and Lyft monies will be put towards directly improving pedestrian crossings at Roberts & Columbus. Ms. Mustone - Well, the Fellsway is an issue for walking to Roberts. Mr. Ruggiero - This is a great report. Let's hope we can continue to improve our walking numbers. Ms. Ellery Klein - Roberts has participated in this for 4 years now. With the nice fall weather, we have seen at least 3 times more students walking to school. Student end up realizing that walking a ½ mile really isn't that far! Plus it starts the day off nicely. Ms. Van der Kloot - Can someone explain the bicycle image painted down middle of Playstead Road? Mr. Blake - The Bike Commission has asked that we identify bike lanes - bikes can occupy any lane, not just side lane. Ms. McGivern - Our hope is that walking to school is added into the schools wellness policies and that possibly a PTO will take it on, so it becomes sustainable. Motion to approve this report and place on file - Motion carries

Report on Coordinated Program Review (CPR) - Ms. Kathleen Medaglio, Mr. Paul D'Alleva, Mr.. Paul Teixeira, Mr. Chad Fallon & Ms. Jill Sawyer. Ms. Medaglio - We are very pleased with our overall review. Every school district participates in this review, every 6 years, and focuses on special education, civil rights, EL programs and CVTE programs at MVTHS - very long & substantive review process that included substantial submission of documents to DESE. During the site visit phase the visiting team interviewed staff/parents/students, parents completed surveys, there were visits to classrooms and building tours. It is a very comprehensive review of programs. Of the 59 special ed criterion reviewed, the visiting team identified one item in need of correction. IEP Teams are required to develop transition plans for all students from age 13 thru end of high school and to update these plans at least once annually. (3) plans were identified as not being updated during the last IEP meeting as required. Internal review of these (3) folders revealed that these students had IEPs updated in response to a transfer between schools. We revised our process and provided professional development to ETLs to update all transition plans during building transfers, so we have already addressed this. A second item was related to a typo in the student handbook that Mr. D'Alleva addressed over the summer. Of the (28) civil rights criterion reviewed the district was cited on two items that related to student handbook language. Mr.D'Alleva explained the high school No Credit Received (NCR) policy. To be consistent with a Chapter 222 requirement, the high school handbook was revised to read that suspensions will not be included in the NCR calculations moving forward. We were able to

do this prior to distribution of handbooks. We are a little above the curve in compliance. Ms. Medaglio - The Department of Education provides school districts with (1) year to correct anything not in compliance. We expect to submit corrective action documentation to demonstrate our plan has been completed in time for our first progress report due at the end of November.

Ms. DiBenedetto - For a district this size for this small amount of corrective action, this is great. I just wanted to read a part under civil rights part ...feedback was very complimentary to Medford's staff. This says a lot of what Medford is all about! Exceptional and very impressed. Wonderful job!

Ms. Kreatz - Ms. Melanie McLaughlin would have liked to be here for this presentation. Could you meet with her to go over the findings?

Ms. Medaglio - I have already communicated with her and offered to review this report at the November 1 Special Education subcommittee mtg or to meet with SEPAC to review. Plus the report will be posted on the school's website and the Department of Education's website.

Mr. Ruggiero - I would like to make a motion to refer this request to the Special Education subcommittee.

Ms. DiBenedetto - The Special Education subcommittee meeting is posted for 5:30 - 7 PM. I have no problem going over it at the meeting. However, the CPR was listed on our agenda, and it was publicized. The program was exceptional, while I would love to give time to this, there are many other issues, that I feel have to be addressed at our next meeting as well.

Mr. Ruggiero - I am very impressed with results.

Mr. Teixeira - We had one area that needed corrective action. That was the middle school schedule. We knew this was going to be coming, I reported it at budget time and you authorized an additional EL teacher which allowed us to implement the new schedule. So we already did our corrective action.

Ms. DiBenedetto - I'd like to point out that previously, the middle school was set up a different way because that's how DESE wanted it during the last review and then we were told to do it another way. So we have adjusted through all these changes and are complying. How are changes going?

Mr. Teixeira - Our EL population has more than doubled, from the time we had the last CPR report. The DESE provides a new guidance document each year on the identification, placement and programming for English learners. Sometimes I describe this as, "Building a plane while they fly it!" Everything at the middle school is going really well. Students and staff are excited, and the school within a school no longer exists.

Mr. Fallon - A complete review of our 17 programs occurred, plus a safety review. Most of our corrective actions were clerical. Just a note, the last CPR was completed (3) principals ago! We had (9) items highlighted as in need of corrective action, with (2) of those dealing directly with safety issues. (3) of the (9) have already been addressed and/or redesigned to avoid issues in the future. We have (4) remaining issues left and we have a year in which to respond to those. The safety report revealed some items that can be easily addressed, including proper signage, eye wash stations, and locks, as well as, other items that may require capital planning funding. I do feel that this report gave Ms. Sawyer and myself a chance to get into all of our programs.

Mr. Ruggiero - How many students were involved with the work papers item?

Ms. Sawyer - Only (1) student, he was a senior and his work permit was not in his file.

Mr. Ruggiero - And the teachers?

Mr. Fallon - One teacher, when our program was

opened, there wasn't a license available. Now there is. The other teacher issue has been addressed, just required some additional paperwork. Ms. Van der Kloot - What about the School Committee being invited to the Advisory Committee? Mr. Fallon - Yes, you will be invited to the Spring Advisory Committee Meeting. Motion to approve and place this report on file by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatez, motion passes.

Report on Bistro 489 Opening - Mr. Fallon - Our sales have doubled since last year. Faculty and staff are enjoying it. Our feedback has been wonderful. Medford Transcript came in, did article. Culinary is 2nd highest program chosen by freshmen. The culinary teachers thank the community for their support. Ms. DiBenedetto - I enjoyed eating there for lunch. Will they be planning to sell pies and goodies for the holidays? Mr. Fallon - They are discussing that now. Ms. Kreatez - I also enjoyed the lunch there. I was wondering if a service directory could be posted somewhere in Bistro, so when people order, they can see what other services they could obtain at MVTHS. Mr. Fallon - That is in process. We are also looking to promote to our senior citizens...they could obtain a service in Cosmetology, have their car checked for the winter and then have lunch in the Bistro. Motion to accept report and place on file - Motion passes.

Recommendation for approval of graduation - June 5, 2019 - Motion to approve Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll Call Vote - (5) in the affirmative, (2) absent, motion passes

Ms. DiBenedetto - Motion to wish Ms. Mustone a Happy Birthday! Motion carries

Ms. Mustone - Please all rise for moment of silence in memory of Ms. Sandra Doerrer, Mr. George B. Gumbleton, and Ms. Ellena "Helen" Clements.

Ms. DiBenedetto makes motion to adjourn, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Meeting adjourned 8:50 PM